

University of Virginia Department of Surgery

Categorical Resident Travel Policy

This policy provides guidelines for categorical residents in the Department of Surgery for travel expenses related to attending and presenting original scientific work at regional and national meetings, as well as selected national meetings and career development workshops.

Meetings Eligible for Department of Surgery Reimbursement

Resident Presenting Research

- PI must review and provide direction related to abstract submission and travel funding availability prior to any submission.
- All abstracts must be submitted to and approved by the PI prior to submission for conference presentation.
- Research Year Residents on T32 grant:
 - Travel is supported by funds available for the respective T32 grant during the research years only. Costs for travel that exceed the funds available from the T32 grant must be covered by the mentor.
 - Funding limit from T32 per year is \$2,000, any cost above will need to be covered by the mentor.
- Research Year Residents **not** on T32 grant:
 - Travel is funded by a grant when available.
 - When grant funding is not available, the department will contribute up to \$1,500 per year per UVA resident. The PI is responsible for any additional funding requested above the \$1,500.
- Outside of Research years:
 - If presenting research, serving on panels or committees the department will contribute up to \$1,500 for one trip per resident per year in years 2 - 6. Additional funding must be provided by the PI or covered by the resident.
 - Clinical residents are allowed to go to more than 1 meeting per year contingent on a PI funding the travel.
- The Program Director and Scheduling Chief must review and approve all travel for clinical residents to ensure all clinical responsibilities are covered. The Chief Resident of the service must be informed of travel approval. Medical student travel will be covered exclusively by the PI.
- Funding Note: If the resident is not paid a wage or stipend from the grant travel expenses cannot be paid from that grant.

Resident Professional Development (Integrated Thoracic, Integrated Vascular, General Surgery)

- Allotted \$2,000 in total to be used during the 3rd, 4th or 5th years for travel or professional development expenses.
- Timing of the professional development will be determined after discussion with, and approval from the Program Director and Department Leadership.
- Travel application must be submitted to the Program Coordinator for approval prior to booking any travel.
- Residents are encouraged to apply for society travel awards to support attendance at AAS courses. If residents are awarded support from the AAS, the department will also contribute up to \$1,000 if needed one time per resident.

Fellowship Professional Development (Thoracic, Vascular, Transplant)

- Allotted \$2,000 in total to be used once during their fellowship for travel or professional development expenses.
- Timing of the professional development will be determined after discussion with, and approval from the Program Director and Department Leadership.
- Travel application must be submitted to the Program Coordinator for approval prior to booking any travel.
- The Program Director and Scheduling Chief must review and approve all travel for clinical residents to ensure all clinical responsibilities are covered. The Chief Resident of the service must be informed of travel approval. Clinical instructor travel will be covered exclusively by the respective Division and handled by the division support staff, subject to approval by the faculty sponsor.

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Travel Rules:

- The travel application must be completed, and the application approved by Program Director, PI (when applicable), and Scheduling Chief, then forwarded to Program Coordinator.
- Travel for clinical residents will be booked by the program coordinators. Travel for research residents will be booked by the administrative assistant for the Division of Surgical Science.
 - All travel must be booked 45 days prior to travel.
 - Flight change charges will not be reimbursed, unless approved by program director
 - Travel will not be allowed if requested less than 2 weeks before travel date, unless approved by program director or PI.
- If trainee is presenting research during clinical years, lodging is restricted to a maximum of 2 consecutive nights. Exceptions can be granted by Program Director.
- For research residents, when presenting at a conference if lodging exceeds 2 nights PI/Mentor must approve.
- If more than one resident is attending the meeting, residents should share rooms when possible and appropriate.
- Registration fees are limited to early and/or trainee registration rates. The trainee will be responsible for the cost difference between early and late registrations fees.
- Lodging rates cannot exceed the designated meeting hotel rate.
- Travel meals will be reimbursed utilizing the Per Diem meal allowance in Workday expense system.
 - Meals provided by the conference must be excluded from reimbursement
 - The daily Per Diem covers meals, coffee, snacks, etc.
- Group meals will not be reimbursed. Each traveler should pay for their own expenses.
- Receipts must be submitted to the designated Surgery Department representative for reimbursement **within 25 days** of the travel return date.
 - Because flights, hotels, and conference registration are booked by the Department, the only receipts to submit will generally be: airport parking, transportation to and from airport, transportation to and from hotel.
- Use of uber/lift/taxi will be reimbursed for travel:
 - to/from home to airport
 - to/from airport to conference hotel
- If a trainee elects to extend a trip for personal reasons, the **Department/Division will not cover any additional costs**, including but not limited to:
 - Airfare -- must attach copy of costs comparing flights adhering to travel policy and the personal stay flights to the expense report
 - Department will only cover up to the cost of flights adhering to travel policy
 - Airfare change fees
 - Additional hotel nights
 - Other expenses related to delayed or extended travel
- If weather conditions threaten major travel disruptions and airlines or hotels are offering exceptions or waivers, **every reasonable effort should be made to return home early**, unless the fellow has not yet presented.
- Contacts for each area:
 - General Surgery – Erin Muhleisen & Kristen Dudley
 - Thoracic – Breana Rose
 - Vascular – Heather Trainum
 - Transplant – Lynn Good
 - Research – Michael Freeman